CANEDERLI WITH SPECK AND BROWN BUTTER

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
North	**4-6**	**1 h 30 min plus drying the bread overnight**

INGREDIENTS

397 g	Jewish-style rye bread
474 g	Milk
56 g	Olive oil
204 g	Onions, finely diced
200 g	Eggs, mixed
85 g	Speck, in a slab, finely diced
40 g	All-purpose flour
10 g	Parsley, finely chopped
171 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed, to finish
30 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated, to finish
10 g	Chives, finely sliced, to finish

METHOD

1. Cut the bread into 1-inch cubes and spread them on a sheet pan to dry out overnight. If you need them sooner, hold the pan in a 200°F oven for an hour, long enough to harden without taking colour. Cool.
2. Tip the cubes into a large bowl, pour the milk over and leave 20 to 30 minutes, until no hard centres remain.
3. Meanwhile set a sauté pan over medium-low heat with the oil and onions. Give them 15 to 20 minutes, to the point where they are only starting to caramelise. Turn them out into a bowl and let them cool.
4. Fold the cooled onions into the soaked bread along with the eggs, speck, flour and parsley. Press out any lump of bread that has survived, so the mixture is even throughout.
5. Cover and chill 30 minutes to 1 hour.
6. Roll the mixture into 18 canederli.
7. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to the boil. Line a sheet pan with parchment.
8. Drop in half the dumplings and bring the heat down to a bare simmer. Give them 20 to 25 minutes, until soft without collapsing. Lift them out onto the lined pan and repeat with the rest, keeping the batches apart. Dip the first batch back into the pot at the end to bring it up to heat.
9. Melt the butter in a saucepan over medium-low heat and take it to golden and foaming, 2 to 3 minutes. Hold it warm.
10. Divide the dumplings between bowls and spoon the butter over, enough that a little pools underneath. Finish with the parmigiano and the chives.

SHAPING



1



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3

NOTES

Cook them in two batches. A pot loaded all at once will not cook evenly.
These are the Italian side of the Austrian Knödel, and what makes them Italian is the parmigiano and the speck.
Spinach is the usual swap for the speck. The parmigiano stays either way.
The other way to serve them is in brodo rather than butter.
The overnight dry matters more than it looks. Bread that is still soft turns to paste once the milk goes in.

DOUGH

Canederli Dough

Makes: 18 pieces / Active Time: 30 min / Rest: 30 min to 1 h chilled, after an overnight dry for the bread

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4. Fold the cooled onions into the soaked bread along with the eggs, speck, flour and parsley. Press out any lump of bread that has survived, so the mixture is even throughout.
5. Cover and chill 30 minutes to 1 hour before rolling into balls.

NOTES

This is a bread dumpling mixture rather than a flour-and-egg dough, so there is no kneading and no gluten to develop.
The overnight dry matters more than it looks. Bread still soft in the middle turns to paste once the milk goes in.
Let the onions cool before they meet the eggs, or the eggs start to set.
Spinach is the usual swap for the speck.
Rolls into 18 canederli at roughly 54 g each.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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